



Ref: SSFL/Stock Exchange/2026-27/068

October 07, 2026

To
BSE Limited,
Department of Corporate Services
P. J. Towers, 25th Floor,
Dalal Street,
Mumbai – 400001

To
National Stock Exchange of India Limited,
Listing Department
Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (E)
Mumbai – 400051

Scrip Code: 542759 and 890221

Symbol: SPANDANA and SSFLPP

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Intimation of Credit Rating - Revision of rating outlook and reaffirmation of rating for NCDs and Bank loans of the Company by India Ratings and Research Private Limited.

Pursuant to Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, we hereby inform that India Ratings and Research Private Limited has revised its rating outlook to 'Stable' and reaffirmed the rating at 'IND BBB+' as detailed below:

S. No.	Facilities/ Instruments	Size of Issue (INR Million)	Rating Assigned/Action
1.	Non-Convertible Debentures	5,000 (reduced from 11,200)	IND BBB+/Stable (Affirmed; Outlook revised to Stable)
2.	Bank Loans	10,000 (reduced from 15,000)	IND BBB+/ Stable (Affirmed; Outlook revised to Stable)

Please find enclosed rationale as published by India Ratings and Research Private Limited on October 07, 2026.

Kindly take the same on record.

Thanking You.

**Yours Sincerely,
For Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited**

VINAY PRAKASH
TRIPATHI
Digitally signed by VINAY
PRAKASH TRIPATHI
Date: 2026.10.07 19:35:18
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**Vinay Prakash Tripathi
Company Secretary**

Encl: as above

Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited

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India Ratings Revised Outlook on Spandana Sphoorty Financial's NCDs and Bank Loans to Stable; Affirms at 'IND BBB+'

Oct 07, 2026 | Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited | Microfinance Institutions

India Ratings and Research (Ind-Ra) has revised the Outlook on Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited's (Spandana) non-convertible debentures (NCDs) and bank facilities while affirming the rating on them at 'IND BBB+' as follows:

Details of Instruments

Instrument Type	Regulator of Instrument	Date of Issuance	Coupon Rate	Maturity Date	Size of Issue (INR million)	Rating Assigned with Outlook/Watch	Rating Action
Non-convertible debentures*	Refer ISIN annexure	-	-	-	5,000 (reduced from 11,200)	IND BBB+/Stable	Affirmed; Outlook revised to Stable
Bank loan facilities	RBI	-	-	-	10,000 (reduced from 15,000)	IND BBB+/Stable	Affirmed; Outlook revised to Stable

*Details in annexure

Analytical Approach

Ind-Ra continues to fully consolidate Spandana's 100% subsidiaries Criss Financial Limited (debt rated at 'IND BBB'/Positive) and Caspian Financial Services Limited, to arrive at the rating, due to the strategic and operational linkages among them.

Detailed Rationale of the Rating Action

The rating affirmation and Outlook revision to Stable reflect stabilisation in Spandana's credit profile from 2HFY26 following a period of significant stress during FY25 and 1HFY26. The Outlook revision further reflects an improvement in the entity's asset quality indicators in 1QFY27 and stronger collection efficiency in the portfolio originated under the revised underwriting framework following the adoption of the Self-Regulatory Organisation guardrails for microfinance lenders in 1QFY26. Moreover, the company has demonstrated profitability from 4QFY26 after reporting significant losses in FY25 and 9MFY26. While profitability remained weak due to a sharp contraction in the loan book and consequent deterioration in operating efficiency in FY25 and FY26, Ind-Ra expects the resumption of disbursement growth from 2HFY26 to support a gradual improvement in earnings through better operating leverage and lower incremental credit costs. Furthermore, the company's capitalisation profile remains comfortable, supported by moderate leverage levels and the capital infusion through the rights issue.

The rating is however constrained by the company's relatively elevated cost of borrowings compared to similarly rated peers. It also reflects the structural risks inherent in the microfinance sector, including the unsecured nature of the portfolio, the sensitivity of the borrower segment to external disruptions, the potential for socio-political interventions and evolving regulatory requirements. Ind-Ra notes the proposed merger of Criss Financial Limited (CFL) with the company, which has received board approval and remains subject to the requisite approvals. However, as the company's credit profile is already assessed on a consolidated basis, the proposed merger is not expected to materially alter the overall credit assessment.

List of Key Rating Drivers

Strengths

- Healthy capitalisation profile
- Improving asset quality indicators
- Geographically diversified portfolio

Weaknesses

- Modest profitability profile
- Scope to strengthen funding profile
- Risks associated with microfinance business

Detailed Description of Key Rating Drivers

Healthy Capitalisation Profile: Spandana maintain a healthy capitalisation profile, with a consolidated net worth (adjusted for deferred tax assets, intangibles and goodwill) of INR14,218.4 million as of 1QFY27 (FY26: INR14,062.7 million; FY25: INR21,378.8 million; FY24: INR34,898.0 million). While the net worth witnessed significant erosion due to the losses incurred during FY25 and FY26, the moderation in the scale of operations during the period helped maintain comfortable capital adequacy. Accordingly, the standalone capital adequacy ratio at 28.6% as of 1QFY27 (FY26: 29.8%; FY25: 36.3%; FY24: 32.0%) remained well above the regulatory minimum requirement of 15%, supported by periodic equity infusions. The consolidated capital-to-risk weighted assets ratio (CRAR) stood at 33.8% as of 1QFY27 (FY26: 35.9%; FY25: 37.1%), while consolidated leverage (outstanding debt-to-tangible net worth) was 3.0x (2.8x; 2.6x; 2.7x). The capitalisation profile was further supported by the infusion of INR2,000 million through a partly paid rights issue in August 2025, raised from promoters and institutional investors, against the total issue size of INR4,000 million, with the balance amount received in 2QFY27.

Improving Asset Quality Indicators: Spandana's asset quality has improved following significant stress between FY25 and 1HFY26, driven by borrower over-indebtedness, elevated field staff attrition, and sociopolitical disruptions. The company had undertaken sizeable write-offs of INR16,176 million in FY25 and INR13,348.9 million in FY26 on a consolidated basis, resulting in its asset under maintenance (AUM) moderating to INR39,480 million as of December 2025 from peak levels of INR119,730 million as of March 2024. Subsequently, with the easing of asset quality pressures and a recovery in business momentum, AUM increased to INR48,870 million as of June 2026.

The company undertaken a comprehensive strengthening of its credit underwriting framework by implementing industry guardrails for microfinance lenders, aimed at improving portfolio quality and curbing fresh stress. This has significantly enhanced the quality of Spandana's incremental originations from 2QFY26. As of June 2026, around 91% of the AUM comprised loans originated under the revised underwriting framework, with 99.2% of such accounts remaining current. Reflecting the success of these corrective measures, monthly collection efficiency (collections as a percentage of current month's demand) improved to 95.9% in 1QFY27 (1QFY26: 90.6%).

Furthermore, the proportion of borrowers with exposure to over three microfinance lenders reduced sharply to 3.7% as of June 2026 (July 2025: 18.0%), indicating lower borrower leverage. On a standalone basis, the company's 0+ days par due (dpd) and 30+dpd moderated to 4.6% and 4.2%, respectively, as of June 2026 and 5.8% and 5.6% as of March 2026 from 18.4% and 15.4% as of June 2025. The consolidated 0+dpd and 30+dpd moderated to 4.9% and 4.4%, respectively, as of June 2026 compared to 17.4% and 14.8% as of March 2025.

Reflecting the improvement in asset quality metrics, the company's credit costs moderated during 4QFY26 and 1QFY27 following the significant clean-up of legacy stressed portfolio and the stronger performance of newly originated book. Also, provisioning remained prudent, with the provision coverage ratio on Stage 3 assets (consolidated) remaining strong at 80.6% in FY26 and 81.2% in 1QFY27, providing a comfortable buffer against residual stress in the portfolio. The company's ability to maintain underwriting discipline, onboard borrowers with stronger credit profiles, recruit and retain field staff, and sustain the recent improvement in asset quality metrics will remain key monitorables.

Geographically Diversified Portfolio: At the consolidated level, Spandana's loan operations were spread across 20 states and 1,443 branches as of June 2026 compared to 20 states and 1,457 branches as of March 2026 (March 2025: 20 states and 1,804 branches). The active borrower base stood at 1.1 million as of June 2026 and 1.2 million as of March 2026 (March 2025: 2.5 million). The top state, Madhya Pradesh, accounted for 14.6% of the standalone AUM and the top three states, i.e. Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, and Bihar, contributed 40.5% to AUM as of June 2026 (March 2026: 14.7% and 40.6%; March 2025: 13.4% and 37.9%). As of June 2026, no state accounted for over 15% of the overall standalone AUM.

Ind-Ra expects the single-state concentration to reduce further, as the company expands its portfolio in the medium term. As of June 2026, the top five states in terms of portfolio concentration, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Odisha, West Bengal, and Andhra Pradesh, contributed 59.3% to the AUM. Spandana's consolidated AUM moderated to INR44.200 million as of March 2026 (March 2024: INR119,730 million) and stood at INR48,870 million as of June 2026 due to lower disbursements in 1HFY26 and substantial write-offs undertaken in FY26 and FY25 .

Modest Profitability: SSFL's profitability deteriorated sharply over FY25-FY26, with the company reporting consolidated losses of INR10,352 million in FY25 and INR6991.5 million in FY26 (FY24: INR5,007 million). The weakening in earnings was primarily attributable to elevated credit costs arising from significant asset quality stress and consequent technical write-offs, resulting in credit costs (as percentage of average assets) increasing to 18.7% in FY25 and 10.7% in FY26 (FY24: 2.3%). Profitability was further impacted by pressure on net interest margins, with the average cost of funds increasing to 13.2% in 4QFY26 from (4QFY25: 12.1%), alongside elevated operating expenses due to intensified collection efforts and a sharp contraction in AUM, which affected operating leverage. However, the company has remained profitable on a quarterly basis with a modest profit of INR52.7 million for 4QFY26. Furthermore, driven by the moderation in credit costs during 1QFY27, led by a write-back of excessive provisions, the company has reported profits of INR118.8 million. Its cost-to-income ratio stood at 90.5% for 1QFY27 and 136.7% for FY26 on account of the increased focus on collections from the delinquent portfolio. The improving forward-flow trends in 2HFY26 indicate a gradual stabilisation in portfolio performance. As disbursements and AUM growth gain momentum, the company is likely to benefit from improved operating leverage, moderation in incremental credit costs, and lower funding costs, which should support a gradual recovery in profitability over the medium term.

Scope to Strengthen Funding Profile: As of June 2026, Spandana's funding profile comprised NCDs (31.4%), pass-through certificates (29.4%), term loans from banks (25.3%) and term loans from non-banks/financial institutions (13.9%). The share of bank funding in on-balance sheet borrowings had declined to 22.5% as of March 2026 (March 2025: 36.5%; March 2024: 44.2%), before improving to 25.3% as of June 2026. Total borrowings reduced significantly to INR39,427.3 million in FY26 (FY25: INR56,556.3 million; FY24: INR94,246.1 million), reflecting moderated business volumes amid elevated asset quality stress and lower disbursements. However, borrowings increased to INR42,911.4 million as of June 2026 with disbursement momentum improving from 2HFY26, supported by fresh borrowings of INR31,164.0 million in FY26 and INR15,965.6 million in 1QFY27. As of June 2026, the company had lending relationships with 39 lenders, comprising 20 non-banks/financial institutions, 17 banks, and 2 development financial institutions, reflecting a diversified funding base. While Spandana's cost of borrowing remains higher than that of some industry peers, funding costs have started moderating, with the marginal cost of borrowings declining to 11.3% in 1QFY27 from a peak of 13.2% in 3QFY26. The company's ability to maintain a diversified funding profile, sustain lender confidence, and access funding at competitive rates will remain a key monitorable.

Risks Associated with Microfinance Business: The microfinance segment as such is vulnerable to socio-political, climatic risks, and operational risks associated with a marginal borrower profile, higher borrower attrition, field staff attrition, overleveraging, multiple lending, among others. Geographical diversification will act as a mitigating factor for the socio-political risk, while improved underwriting capabilities, along with a strong collection mechanism and higher employee retention, will be key to manage strong growth in the sector. Furthermore, the microfinance sector is regulated by multiple bodies, which, from time to time, provide several directives to maintain credit discipline and avoid over indebtedness for borrowers. Ind-Ra will continue to monitor SSFL's ability to withstand such economic shocks while maintaining the asset quality and profitability metrics.

Liquidity

Adequate: As of August 2026, Spandana maintained a comfortable liquidity position, with unencumbered cash and cash equivalents of INR9,120 million sufficient to cover scheduled debt repayments and operating expenses of INR5,870 million due in September 2026. In line with its internal liquidity policy, the company maintains liquidity equivalent to at least one month's debt obligations and three months of operating expenses in the form of unencumbered funds. Liquidity is further supported by expected average monthly collections of nearly INR3,470 million during September to November 2026, as well as the anticipated receipt of the balance INR2,000 million equity infusion by end-September 2026. Also, Spandana's standalone asset-liability maturity profile remained comfortable as of 30 June 2026, with a positive cumulative mismatch across all maturity buckets, indicating adequate liquidity buffers to meet its near-term obligations.

Rating Sensitivities

Positive: A significant scale-up in AUM with geographical diversification, while maintaining stable asset quality performance, and a significant improvement in the earnings profile, along with improving funding profile diversification and a reduction in the cost of borrowings in line with peers, could lead to a positive rating action.

Negative: Significant deterioration in the asset quality, adversely impacting profitability, funding challenges, leading to a dilution in liquidity, a moderation in the capitalisation profile, with the leverage exceeding 4.0x, all on a sustained basis could lead to a negative rating action.

Any Other Information

Not applicable

ESG Issues

ESG Factors Minimally Relevant to Rating: Unless otherwise disclosed in this section, the ESG issues are credit neutral or have only a minimal credit impact on Spandana, due to either their nature or the way in which they are being managed by the entity. For more information on Ind-Ra’s ESG Relevance Disclosures, please [click here](#). For answers to frequently asked questions regarding ESG Relevance Disclosures and their impact on ratings, please [click here](#).

About the Company

Spandana was incorporated on 10 March 2003 as an NBFC after it took over the microfinance operations of a non-governmental organisation in 1998. The company was classified as an NBFC– microfinance institution effective 13 April 2015. It was listed on the stock exchange in August 2019 post an initial public offering of its equity shares. As on 30 June 2026, Spandana had operations in 20 states/union territories spanning across 1,443 branches with an outstanding AUM of INR48,870 million.

Key Financial Indicators

Particulars (INR million) - Consolidated	1QFY27	FY26	FY25
Total tangible assets*	58781	55,231	79,981
Total tangible equity*	14,218.4	14,062.7	21,378.8
Net profit	118.8	-6,991.50	-10,351.60
Return on average assets (%)	0.8	-10.3	-9.8
Equity/assets (%)	24.2	25.5	26.7
Total capital ratio (%)	33.8	35.9	37.1
Source: Spandana; Ind-Ra			
*Total assets and equity adjusted for deferred tax assets, good-will and intangibles			
Note: All ratios in the rating rationale are as per Ind-Ra methodology and can vary from those reported by the company.			

Status of Non-Cooperation with Previous Rating Agency

Not applicable

Rating History

Instrument Type	Current Rating/Outlook			Historical Rating/Outlook									
	Rating Type	Rated Limits (INR million)	Current Rating	14 October 2025	26 August 2025	10 June 2025	12 February 2025	27 December 2024	8 October 2024	19 August 2024	24 June 2024	11 September 2023	30 May 2023
Non-convertible debentures	Long-term	5,000	IND BBB+ /Stable	IND BBB+ /Negative	IND BBB+ /Negative	IND A-/Negative	IND A-/Negative	IND A+/Negative	IND A+/Stable	IND A+/Stable	IND A+/Stable	IND A/Stable	IND A/Stable
Bank loan facilities	Long-term	10,000	IND BBB+ /Stable	IND BBB+ /Negative	IND BBB+ /Negative	IND A-/Negative	IND A-/Negative	IND A+/Negative	IND A+/Stable	IND A+/Stable	IND A+/Stable	IND A/Stable	IND A/Stable
Commercial paper	Short-term	5000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	WD	IND A1	IND A1
Principal protected market-linked debentures	Long-term	9,200	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	WD	IND PP-MLD A/Stable	IND PP-MLD A/Stable

Disclosure on instruments / activities and names of regulators:

A list of products/activities or ratings of instruments falling under the purview of various financial sector regulators (FSRs) along with the names of respective FSRs has been duly disclosed by Ind-Ra on its website. A link to the same has been provided below for ready reference:

Rating Activities

Note: Kindly note that for activities or instruments falling under the purview of FSRs other than SEBI, the grievance/dispute redressal mechanisms and investor protection mechanisms provided by SEBI shall not be available.

Bank wise Facilities Details

The details are as reported by the issuer as on (07 Oct 2026)

#	Bank Name	Instrument Description	Rated Amount (INR million)	Rating
1	Arohan Financial Services Limited	Term Loan	140.7657	IND BBB+/Stable

2	Arohan Financial Services Limited	Term Loan	239.51783	IND BBB+/Stable
3	Black Soil Capital Pvt. Ltd.	Term Loan	395.83333	IND BBB+/Stable
4	Federal Bank	Term Loan	145.83333	IND BBB+/Stable
5	Federal Bank	Term Loan	145.83333	IND BBB+/Stable
6	Federal Bank	Term Loan	145.83333	IND BBB+/Stable
7	Federal Bank	Term Loan	145.83333	IND BBB+/Stable
8	Hongkong Shanghai Banking corporation	Term Loan	666.66667	IND BBB+/Stable
9	IDFC First Bank	Term Loan	333.33333	IND BBB+/Stable
10	IDFC First Bank	Term Loan	1125	IND BBB+/Stable
11	NABKISAN Finance Ltd	Term Loan	250	IND BBB+/Stable
12	Northern ARC Capital Limited	Term Loan	354.17804	IND BBB+/Stable
13	Northern ARC Capital Limited	Term Loan	52.39207	IND BBB+/Stable
14	Northern ARC Capital Limited	Term Loan	166.664	IND BBB+/Stable
15	NA	Bank loan (Unutilised)	5692.31571	IND BBB+/Stable

Complexity Level of the Instruments

Instrument Type	Complexity Indicator
Bank loan facilities	Low
Non-convertible debentures	Low

For details on the complexity level of the instruments, please visit <https://www.indiaratings.co.in/complexity-indicators>.

Annexure

Instrument Type	ISIN	Regulator of instruments	Date of Issuance	Coupon Rate (%)	Maturity Date	Rating/Outlook	Outstanding /Rated Amount (INR million)
Non-convertible debentures#	INE572J07554	SEBI	10 April 2023	10.25	25 May 2026	WD	250
Non-convertible debentures#	INE572J07398	SEBI	24 March 2022	11.85	24 March 2028	WD	350
Non-convertible debentures#	INE572J07612	SEBI	4 September 2023	10.75	4 September 2026	WD	1,500
Non-convertible debentures#	INE572J07679	SEBI	7 March 2024	10.75	3 April 2026	WD	700
Non-convertible debentures#	INE572J07695	SEBI	21 March 2024	10.75	21 December 2026	WD	500
Non-convertible debentures	INE572J07760	SEBI	24 October 2025	11	30 April 2028	IND BBB+/Stable	4,000
Non-convertible debentures	INE572J07778	SEBI	17 December 2025	11.25	17 December 2027	IND BBB+/Stable	743.75
Non-convertible debentures#	INE572J07513	SEBI	30 December 2022	11.35	30 December 2025	WD	1,000
Non-convertible debentures#	INE572J07653	SEBI	18 December 2023	10.11	18 December 2025	WD	2,000
Non-convertible debentures*#	INE572J07745	SEBI	24 April 2023	11.1	24 April 2026	WD	1,000
Non-convertible debentures		SEBI			Utilised Limits		4,743.75
Non-convertible debentures		SEBI			Unutilised Limits		256.25
Non-convertible debentures					Total Limits**		5,000

Source: Company; NSDL *ISIN no. INE572J07570 merged with ISIN no. INE572J07745 **Utilised limits do not include withdrawn ISINs # paid in full

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About India Ratings

India Ratings and Research (Ind-Ra) is India's SEBI registered credit rating agency committed to providing India's credit markets accurate, timely and prospective credit opinions. Built on a foundation of independent thinking, rigorous analytics, and an open and balanced approach towards credit research, Ind-Ra has grown rapidly during the past decade, gaining significant market presence in India's fixed income market.

Ind-Ra currently maintains coverage of corporate issuers, financial institutions (including banks and insurance companies), finance companies, urban local bodies, and structured finance and project finance companies.

Headquartered in Mumbai, Ind-Ra has seven branch offices located in Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Chennai, Gurugram, Hyderabad, Kolkata and Pune. Ind-Ra is recognised by the Securities and Exchange Board of India and the Reserve Bank of India.

Ind-Ra is a 100% owned subsidiary of the Fitch Group.

Solicitation Disclosures

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APPLICABLE CRITERIA AND POLICIES

Financial Institutions Rating Criteria

Non-Bank Finance Companies Criteria

The Rating Process

Evaluating Corporate Governance

DISCLAIMER

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